FREE GUIDE · VA INTERVIEW

VA Interview Guide: Newbie to Hired

15 common questions with sample answers. Replace every detail with your own true experience. Never invent clients or results.

What clients look for	How to show it
Communication	Short, clear, direct answers
Reliability	Backup internet and power, on time, EOD reports
Can do the task	Tools, samples, portfolio
Attitude	Honest, learns fast, takes initiative

Before the interview

☐ Re-read the job post: tools, top 3 tasks, time zone, their exact words
☐ Research the business: website, social media, customers
☐ Prepare 4 STAR stories: a problem, a deadline, a new tool, a mistake you fixed
☐ Test internet, backup data, UPS, headset, camera at eye level
☐ Join 5 minutes early with your resume and portfolio open

Tell me about yourself	What to say
1. Present	Who you are now
2. Past	Your background (BPO, school, family business)
3. Skills	3 skills or tools that match the job post
4. Future	Why this role, framed around their needs

QUESTIONS 1 TO 6

Sample answers

1. Tell me about yourself.

Hi, I'm Ana, a virtual assistant from the Philippines. I worked for three years in customer service, handling emails, chat and upset customers. Recently I trained in Google Workspace, Canva and Trello, and I built practice projects like an inbox system and a content calendar. I'm applying because you need someone organised for your inbox and calendar, and that's the work I enjoy.

Why it works: Maikli, may proof, at tugma sa job post.

2. Why do you want to work as a virtual assistant?

I enjoy helping busy people stay organised. As a VA, I can use my communication and admin skills to save business owners time. I also like learning new tools. I'm looking for a long-term role where I can grow with the business.

Why it works: Tungkol sa client at sa long-term, hindi lang sa sahod.

3. Do you have experience as a VA?

Not yet as a paid VA, but I've done very similar work. In my customer service job I answered emails and chats every day and kept records in a CRM. I also finished a practice project where I organised a sample inbox with labels and filters. I can share my portfolio with you now.

Why it works: Tapat, pero ipinapakita ang kaugnay na experience at proof.

4. Why should we hire you?

Because I can help you right away with your inbox and scheduling. I'm reliable: I have backup internet and power. I communicate clearly, I send an end-of-day report, and I ask questions early so mistakes don't happen.

Why it works: Konkreto: task, reliability at komunikasyon.

5. What tools have you used?

I use Google Workspace every day: Gmail, Calendar, Docs and Sheets. I've also used Canva and Trello. I haven't used your tool yet, but I already watched its tutorials, and I'm comfortable learning new software quickly.

Why it works: Tapat sa hindi pa alam, pero may ginawa nang paghahanda.

6. What is your greatest strength?

I'm very organised. I keep a daily task list, confirm deadlines in writing, and double-check my work before sending. In my last job, this helped me keep a high quality score.

Why it works: Isang strength lang, may halimbawa at resulta.

QUESTIONS 7 TO 12

Sample answers

7. What is your weakness?

Sometimes I spend too long trying to make something perfect. Now I set a time limit for each task and ask for feedback early, so I still deliver on time.

Why it works: Totoong weakness, pero may solusyon na ginagawa mo na.

8. Tell me about a time you made a mistake.

I once sent a reply to the wrong customer. I told my team lead right away, apologised to both customers and sent the correct reply. Then I made a short checklist I use before sending any email, and it hasn't happened again.

Why it works: STAR: sitwasyon, ginawa mo, at ang natutunan.

9. How do you prioritise many tasks?

I look at what's urgent and important. Time-sensitive tasks come first, like client replies and meetings, then focused work. If two tasks are both urgent, I ask you which comes first instead of guessing.

Why it works: May sistema, at alam kung kailan magtatanong.

10. How do you handle a difficult customer?

I stay calm, listen, and repeat back what they need so they feel heard. I apologise for the experience, explain what I'll do and by when, then follow up. If it's beyond my role, I escalate it to you with a short summary.

Why it works: Kalma, malinaw na aksyon, at alam kung kailan mag-escalate.

11. Describe your work-from-home setup.

I work from a quiet home office with a laptop, a headset with a noise-cancelling mic, and fibre internet. I have mobile data as a backup and a UPS for power interruptions, so I can keep working during brownouts.

Why it works: Sinasagot ang takot ng client: internet at brownout.

12. Can you work in our time zone?

Yes. Your 9 AM to 5 PM is 6 AM to 2 PM here in the Philippines, and that works for me. I'm available Monday to Friday, and I can be flexible for urgent tasks with notice.

Why it works: Ipinapakita na alam mo na ang oras nila.

QUESTIONS 13 TO 15

Sample answers

13. What is your expected rate?

Based on the tasks in your post and my skills, my rate is $X per hour. I'm open to talking about the scope, and if budget is a concern, we can start with fewer hours and grow from there.

Why it works: Malinaw na numero, flexible sa scope, hindi sa halaga mo.

14. How do you use AI in your work?

I use AI to draft emails and summarise notes faster, but I always check and edit everything before sending. I never put passwords or private customer data into AI, and I only use tools you approve.

Why it works: Marunong sa AI, pero responsable at ligtas.

15. Do you have any questions for us?

Yes! What does a successful first month look like for you? Which tasks take most of your time right now? And how do you prefer to get updates from me?

Why it works: Ipinapakitang seryoso ka at nag-iisip na parang team member.

STAR	Your story
Situation	
Task	
Action	
Result	

THANK-YOU MESSAGE (WITHIN 24 HOURS)

Hi [Name], thank you for your time today. I enjoyed learning about [business] and your plans for [goal]. I'm confident I can help with [task]. I'm happy to do a short paid trial if that helps. Have a great day!

FOLLOW-UP (AFTER 3 TO 5 DAYS)

Hi [Name], I hope your week is going well. I wanted to follow up on the [role] position. I'm still very interested and happy to share more samples if useful. Thank you!

Red flag: if anyone asks you to pay a fee, deposit or "training kit", or asks for OTPs or bank details, it is a scam, not an interview.